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DOST ILOCOS REGION OPENS GROWTH OPPORTUNITIES FOR 25 FIRMS THROUGH TECHNOLOGY NEEDS ASSESSMENT, PAVING THE WAY FOR SETUP SUCCESS

BY: SHESHENIE JANAE M. PEREZ

The Department of Science and Technology Ilocos Region (DOST Ilocos Region) through its Provincial Offices and Regional Program Management Office (RPMO) conducted Technology Needs Assessments (TNA) for twenty-five (25) Micro, Small, and Medium Enterprises (MSMEs) across Region 1 as part of the Small Enterprise Technology Upgrading Program (SETUP). The validation activities served as a critical step for enterprises seeking assistance under SETUP, DOST’s flagship program aimed at enhancing industrial productivity, competitiveness, and innovation among local businesses. During the assessments, the DOST team evaluated the firms’ current production capacity, technology utilization, operational challenges, and opportunities for innovation. Possible interventions such as equipment upgrading, process improvement, technical consultancy, and workforce capability enhancement were identified to help businesses improve productivity and expand their market reach. The assessment also considered gender-responsive needs to ensure inclusivity.



FROM CAMPS TO COMMUNITIES OF OPPORTUNITIES: DOST SOCCSKSARGEN Advances Science for Peace Through Comprehensive Assessment and Monitoring in Mindanao Priority Areas



On April 27 to May 4, 2026, the Department of Science and Technology SOCCSKSARGEN through the direction of Regional Director Engr. Sammy P. Malawan and under the guidance of the DOST Office of the Undersecretary for Regional Operations and in close coordination with the Office of the Presidential Adviser on Peace, Reconciliation and Unity (OPA-

CFO teams up with iPBA to provide free legal aid for Non-Resident Filipinos



Pasay City - The Commission on Filipinos Overseas (CFO) and International Pro Bono Alliance (iPBA) formalized on May 12, 2026 their partnership to make legal assistance more accessible to Filipino migrants and their families. CFO Chairperson, Secretary Dante “Klink” Ang II led the MOU signing, emphasizing how this collaboration will support

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sive and sustainable enterprise development. A total of twenty-five underwent Technology Needs Assessment as part of SETUP, including four from seven (from Findings from the Technology Needs Assessment will determine the firms' eligibility to move forward to the next stage — the preparation of project proposals for further review and possible funding support through the Review and Technical Evaluation Committee (RTEC). Through SETUP, DOST

Ilocos Region continues to empower MSMEs in Region 1 by providing access to appropriate technologies, upgrading equipment, and delivering technical assistance that drive innovation, improve product quality, and create greater market opportunities. By supporting local enterprises through science and technology, DOST Ilocos Region continues to deliver “Agham na Ramdam” by strengthening innovation, improving competitiveness, and helping build more resilient communities across Region 1.

**FROM CAMPS TO COMMUNITIES OF
OPPORTUNITIES: DOST
SOCCSKSARGEN...** From page 1



PRU), conducted a Camp Visitation, Monitoring, and Comprehensive Assessment across identified priority communities in Mindanao under the implementation of the The undertaking forms part of the government's continuing commitment to the Normalization Track of the Comprehensive Agreement on the Bangsamoro (CAB), particularly on the transformation of former conflict-affected communities into empowered, self-sustaining, and development-ready areas through responsive and inclusive interventions. In the week-long activity, DOST SOCCSKSARGEN's Project Management Team (PMT) visited the following acknowledged camps, particularly; Camp Bader in Brgy. Datalpandan, Guindulungan, Maguindanao del Sur, Camp Abubakar in Brgy. Sapad, Matanog, Maguindanao del Norte, Camp Omar in Brgy. Saniag, Ampatuan, Maguindanao del Sur, Camp Rajahmuda in Brgy. Daladagan, Mangudadatu, Maguindanao del Sur, Camp

Bushra in Brgy. Sandab Madaya, Butig, Lanao del Sur and Camp Bilal in Brgy. Biruar, Tangcal, Lanao del Norte. The field activity was carried out in close coordination with the respective Local Government Units (LGUs), the Joint Task Forces on Camps Transformation (JTFC), local peace mechanisms, community leaders, and beneficiary groups to ensure that the assessment process remained participatory, culturally sensitive, and grounded on the actual conditions of the communities. More than a routine inspection, the activity served as a strategic groundwork for identifying science and technology interventions that are responsive to the needs, capacities, and aspirations of the people. Through direct community immersion and on-site validation, the PMT assessed the viability and readiness of each area for possible deployment of livelihood, agricultural, infrastructure, digital, and enterprise-based technologies intended to improve pro-

ductivity and strengthen local economies. The assessment covered key areas such as infrastructure and utilities, agricultural and livelihood potentials, enterprise readiness, technology utilization, and solar installation viability. Potential interventions on food processing, Halal goat and ZamPen Native Chicken production, crop and aquaculture systems, STARBOOKS, dress-making, handloom weaving, and other community-based technologies were likewise evaluated for possible enhancement and expansion. The monitoring activity also enabled the PMT to validate existing interventions, identify operational and technical gaps, and determine the necessary support mechanisms to strengthen implementation. Consultations with beneficiaries and local stakeholders further provided valuable insights on community conditions, livelihood challenges, and development priorities. In communities where years of conflict once limited opportunities and

access to services, the Science for Peace Program continues to serve as a concrete platform for inclusive and peace-responsive development. Through the program, DOST reinforces its commitment to bringing science, technology, and innovation closer to historically underserved communities — transforming technology into a bridge toward resilience, productivity, and lasting peace. Moving forward, DOST SOCCSKSARGEN remains steadfast in strengthening partnerships with OPAPRU, local government units, and peacebuilding stakeholders to sustain interventions that are community-centered, culturally responsive, and anchored on long-term development outcomes. Through continued convergence and meaningful engagement, the agency reaffirms its commitment to ensuring that no community is left behind in the pursuit of peace, progress, and sustainable development in Mindanao.

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CFO teams up with iPBA to provide free legal aid... From page 1



overseas Filipinos, particularly those who lack the financial means to seek legal counsel. On the other hand, Atty. Purificacion Bartolome-Bernabe highlighted the iPBA's vital role in educating the

public through lectures, protecting vulnerable groups, including overseas Filipinos, and building networks with pro bono legal organizations internationally, as well as law schools with legal

clinics in the Philippines. Under the agreement, iPBA will primarily accommodate legal referrals from the CFO for free consultation and counseling. The partnership also covers the delivery of

legal education through lectures and support for various initiatives benefiting overseas Filipinos and their families, both locally and abroad.

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QUEZON MEDIA KUMUSTAHAN SA COCA COLA COMPANY SA LUCBAN, QUEZON

Muling nagkasama-sana ang mga lokal, at nasyunal na Mamamahayag mula sa CALABARZON, upang daluhan ang ginawang patawag ng mga kawani at opisyal ng Coca-Cola Europacific Aboitiz Philippines (CCEAP), upang maisagawa ang "Quezon Media Kumustahan with Staff and Officers ng Coca Cola Company na ginanap mismo sa SAMKARA Restaurant and Garden Resort, sa bayan ng Lucban, Quezon.

Ayon kay Ms.Kamiya Garcia - External Communications Manager, nilalayon ng kanilang kompanya na maging matibay ang samahan ng kompanya, at ng mga miyembro ng Media sa buong Region 4A, partikular na rin dito sa Probinsya ng Quezon.

Sa ganitong

paraan ay magpatuloy ang kanilang promosyon sa Radyo, sa TV, at sa mga Newspaper na mayruon sa nasasakupan ng kanilang hurisdiksyon, lalo na anyang ikinakampanya nila ngayong programang pangkalikasan na masinop na maipon ang mga plastic bottle na siyang ginagawa nilang recycled materials para sa muling paggawa ng mga produkto ng Coca Cola Company. Kaya naman bukod pa rito sila rin anyang patuloy na umaagapay sa mga okasyong isinasagawa sa bayang ito, at ang pagiging partner sa nalalapit na Pahiyas Festival, sa pagkakataong ito ay sinisikap ng mga kawani, at opisyal ng Coca-Cola Europacific Aboitiz Philippines (CCEAP), na dumayo dito sa Lucban, Quezon, para

maisulong ang programang "Tapon To Ipon" na siyang advocacy nila ngayon. Nilalayon ng programang ito na hikayatin ang publiko na huwag basta itapon ang mga plastic bottles, at iba pang recyclable packaging materials mula sa mga produkto nila, na hindi lamang sa bayang ito maging sa buong Calabarzon, at sa ating bansa.

At dahil bahagi ito ng Sustainability Efforts ng Coke tulad ng pag-promote ng Recycling System, upang tuluyang maisagawa ang pagbabawas ng Plastic Waste, at ang paggamit ng Recycled Materials sa mga packaging area, at ang patuloy na maipairal ang Community Clean-Up, at maimulat ang publiko sa kahalagahan ng Environmental Awareness Campaign.

Kaya higit ngayon ang ginagawang kampanya na ito, na puwedeng mag-ipon ng Empty PET Bottles, at kusang madaala sa mga Collection Points o sa mga Partner Junk Shops, kapalit ng mga Incentives, Rewards, o minsan Cash Value na ibibigay sa kanila depende sa programa sa bawat area na nasasakupan ng promosyon ng programa. At sa huli ay inihayag ng mga taga - Coca-Cola Europacific Aboitiz Philippines (CCEAP), na ang datos ay mayroon ng 6,000 Collection Hubs na nakakalat sa ating bansa, para maipairal ang "Tapon to Ipon" Program ng Coke na nagsimula pa noong taong 2021, para maging mabisang maisakatuparan ang ikinakampanyang programa.

SHOWBLITZ

By: Charlene Mae

'Ito ba ang binoto ni-yong Senador' – Kim



Kaila, gagamitin ang boses sa 2028, Bela, inilayo ang sarili kay Robin Padilla! Maraming naka-relate kay Kim Chiu.

Ito ay matapos siyang maglabas ng saloobin sa nangyaring 'the Senate' drama noong Miyerkules ng gabi. May nagpapatok ng baril kaya't maraming nag-panic pero tinutukan ng legit media.

Pero ang ending hindi kaagad nadiskubre kung sino talaga ang nagpapatok na pati ibang senador ay 'di alam ang nangyari.

Ayon lang Kim: "Grabe! Anong nangyayari sa Pilipinas? Bilang normal na Pilipino at nagbabayad ng tamang buwis. Sa aking opinyon, walang mangyayaring ganito kung kusang susuko ang taong nagsasabing wala siyang kasalanan. Pangalawa at huli, eto ba ang binoto niyong senador na nagsasabing magsisilbi sa ating bayan? Panahon na para pag-isipan natin na bumoto ng tama." Naman.

Si Kaila Estrada ay naglabas ng boses para sa 2028 election: "Nanunuod at nakikinig ang mga kabataan. We see what is happening, and we will remember the decisions and actions being made today. "Darating ang 2028, and many people will use their voices and votes to demand better leadership and accountability for the country," pahayag ng girlfriend ni Daniel Padilla.

Halos ganito rin ang sinabi ni Anne Curtis: "Just caught up on the news in the Philippines. Nakakalungkot na umabot sa sitwasyon na ganun, in fact, it's so sad that it even happened. I guess all we can do as citizens and voters is watch, learn, take note and continue to pray for our country."

Samantalang, nagpaliwanag si Bela Padilla sa magkaiba nilang pananaw sa pulitika ng kanyang tiyuhing senador, Sen. Robin Padilla.

Aniya, wala siyang kinalaman kung naging bahagi ito ng kinabibilangan niyang serye na Blood vs Duty na pinagbibidahan nina Richard Gutierrez and Gerald Anderson.

At lalong wala rin kinalaman ang kanyang mga pinaniwalaan sa political affiliation ng kanyang tiyuhin. As of this writing ang umiikot ay na-kaalis na raw ng Senado si Sen. Bato dela Rosa kasama si Sen. Robin Padilla, mga bandang 3:00 a.m. daw noong Huwebes. At inihatid pa raw ito sa NAIA ni Sen. Robin. Kaya naman pati si Bela ay kinukuwestyong na ba't daw nagsalita ito tungkol sa kaso ni Bato pero bakit tahimik lang daw siya sa kanyang tito na pinagbibintangan nga na siyang naging dahilan kaya ito napasama sa kanilang action series.

"Sorry, but, what? I'm

also assigned projects too. I was cast in this project in December. My uncle was added on recently. I have no power whatsoever in casting decisions. Hindi nga ako ang pinakamalaking mukha sa poster. I don't see anyone else from the cast being asked here. Has he added me in any of his films/shows previously? Get your facts straight. We work and are managed separately.

"Because of recent events, and since I'm being asked daily, I wish to express my thoughts on the issue surrounding the casting of my uncle in Blood vs Duty, and the current situation hounding the Senate." Mahaba rin ang kanyang paliwanag tungkol sa relasyon nila bilang magkamag-anak: "Growing up, my tito Robin was kind to me and my family. I will be forever grateful for this. But as our careers flourished and took different directions, with him entering politics, our personal encounters have become scarcer. Our ideologies also differed.

"I do not live close to my uncle. I haven't seen tito Robin until we shared the same call time last Friday. Before then, I saw him 3 years ago.

"My uncle being cast in the show was neither because of my influence nor my being part of the cast. I was cast in December. He is a recent addition to the show. This decision is purely the prerogative of the executive and supervising producers of the show," sabi niya.

Dinagdagan niya pa ito: "My uncle's political affiliation has nothing to do with my personal beliefs and convictions. We are related but we manage to agree to disagree. I remain grateful to his kindness, but I also maintain an independent and personal sense of being in charge of my career, choices and convictions." Samantala, totoo rin ang sinabi Bianca Gonzalez na iba pa rin ang legitimate media pagdating sa coverage. Sa kabila ng pagsulpot ng mga content creator at vlogger, malayo ang sistema ng pagbabalita ng mga totoong journalist. At isa sa nag-trending ay ang Senate reporter na si Victoria Tulad ng ABS-CBN na hindi bumitiw sa pagbibigay ng update sa mga nagaganap noong kainitan ng pangyayari sa senador.

Ganundin si Zyann Ambrosio na trending kahapon ng umaga.

Tumi-trending din si Atty. Jimmy Bondoc. Ang dating singer ang legal counsel ni Sen. Bato dela Rosa na nagsasabi namang nasa loob pa raw ng Senate building ang wanted na senador. Pero iba naman ang sinasabi ng mga nasa NAIA.

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SPORTS NEWS

Cavs puro na sa East Finals



DETROIT — Inagaw ng fourth-seeded Cleveland Cavaliers ang 3-2 lead sa kanilang Eastern Conference semi-final series ng Pistons matapos itakas ang 117-113 overtime win.

Umiskor si James Harden ng play-off-best 30 points at may 21 markers si Donovan Mitchell para pangu-nahan ang Cleveland. Nag-ambag si Max Strus ng 20 points tampok ang anim na three-point shots at may 19 at 16 markers sina Evan Mobley at Jarrett Allen, ayon sa pagkakasunod.

Pinamunuan ni Cade Cunningham ang top-seeded Detroit sa kanyang 39 points at

may 19 markers si Daniss Jenkins kasunod ang 13 points ni Tobias Harris.

Itinala ng Pistons ang isang 15-point lead sa first half at hinawakan ang 103-94 kalamangan sa huling dalawang minuto ng fourth period.

Nakabangon ang Cavaliers at nakatabla sa 103-103 mula sa dalawang free throws ni Mobley sa huling 45.2 segundo. Isang 13-0 atake ang ginawa ng Cleveland kasabay ng pagpapatahimik sa Detroit sa loob ng limang minuto mula sa fourth quarter hanggang sa gitna ng overtime.

Kinuha ng Cavs ang isang seven-point lead sa 2:39 minuto galing sa triple ni Mitchell. Idini-

kit ni Cunningham ang Pistons sa huling 25 segundo mula sa kanyang jumper. Ang dalawang free throws ni Harden ang sumelyo sa panalo ng Cleveland na pamamahalaan ang Game 6 bukas kung saan hangad nilang makasagupa ang New York Knicks sa East finals.

Kung mananalo ang Detroit ay sila ang magho-host sa Game 7 sa Lunes.

Naunang winalis ni Jalen Brunson at ng New York Knicks si Joel Embiid at ang Philadelphia 76ers, 4-0, sa kanilang semi-finals showdown.

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